

News Weekly

Liftoff! NASA Launches Astronauts on Historic Artemis Moon Mission

NASA's Artemis II mission signifies the first crewed lunar flyby in over half a century, launching from Kennedy Space Center aboard the Space Launch System rocket. This mission includes four astronauts aboard the Orion spacecraft, embarking on a 10-day journey aimed at testing life support systems and establishing a foundation for a sustained lunar presence.

- NASA Administrator Jared Isaacman emphasized that Artemis II embodies a broader vision for lunar exploration and future missions to Mars.
- Following the launch, Orion successfully deployed its solar arrays, and the crew began conducting system checks.

NASA Associate Administrator Amit Kshatriya highlighted the importance of this test flight for upcoming missions aimed at reaching the Moon's surface. (Source: NASA)



Italian soccer is in a nightmare that it can't wake up from

After witnessing the final Bosnian penalty slip past him on Tuesday, Italy's goalkeeper Gianluigi Donnarumma remained on his knees, hands on his head in sheer disbelief. His teammates, positioned near the halfway line, either collapsed to the ground or stood frozen as the home crowd erupted, contrasting sharply with the Italian players' world crumbling around them.

The Azzurri had just suffered a defeat to world No. 65 Bosnia and Herzegovina in a penalty shootout, resulting in Italy's absence from this year's World Cup – marking the third consecutive tournament they have failed to qualify for.

Italian publication Gazzetta dello Sport headlined the event as "the third apocalypse," reflecting the deep significance soccer holds in the nation. This situation is hardly believable for a country renowned for producing some of history's greatest players and for a team that has claimed the World Cup title four times, the latest being in 2006. (Source: CNN)



Ancient bone dice reveal 12,000-year history of gambling in America

A new study in *American Antiquity*, a leading journal of North American archaeology published by Cambridge University Press for the Society for American Archaeology, presents compelling evidence that the earliest known dice were created and used by Native American hunter-gatherers more than 12,000 years ago. These discoveries come from the western Great Plains at the end of the last Ice Age and predate the oldest known dice from Bronze Age societies in the Old World by thousands of years. Research led by Colorado State University Ph.D. student Robert J. Madden shows that dice, gambling, and games of chance have deep roots in Native American culture, stretching back at least 12,000 years. The earliest examples come from Late Pleistocene Folsom-period sites in Wyoming, Colorado, and New Mexico. These artifacts are more than 6,000 years older than comparable dice found in the Old World. (Source: Science Daily)



Hershey to return to classic Reese's recipe after founder's grandson criticizes brand



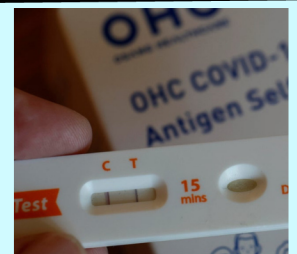
The Hershey Company plans to change the chocolate in some Reese's and Hershey's products by 2027, after criticism from Brad Reese, a founder descendant. They will replace certain compound coatings with traditional milk or dark chocolate, affecting less than 3% of Reese's products. Core recipe for Hershey's bars and Reese's cups will remain unchanged, but products like the Reese's Fast Break bar will be updated. CEO Kirk Tanner also announced plans to revise the Kit Kat recipe for a creamier taste and remove artificial colors by 2027. Brad Reese criticized the changes as insincere, while other family members showed support for Hershey leadership. (Source: Fox)

A new COVID-19 variant called "Cicada" is spreading. Here's what to know.

The term "Cicada" is trending, not due to the seasonal insects, but because of a COVID-19 variant labeled BA.3.2, monitored by the CDC and WHO. First identified in November 2024, BA.3.2 has been detected in at least 23 countries and 25 U.S. states as of February, according to the CDC. While spreading, it has not become the dominant strain. Dr. William Schaffner of Vanderbilt University told CBS News, "Whether it will push itself to the front of the line remains to be seen."

3.2 is part of the Omicron family and has between 70 to 75 mutations. A *Lancet* study indicated that the current vaccine is less effective against BA.3.2 but still offers some protection. Dr. Schaffner noted, "These are still early days, but this new variant seems capable of evading some protections."

The CDC has not reported a nationwide increase in severe COVID-19 cases. Trends show declines in case rates, emergency visits, and hospitalizations. However, Massachusetts and Florida may see an increase in cases. Dr. Celine Gounder of CBS News stated, "We haven't seen evidence of this variant causing more severe disease or an increase in hospitalizations elsewhere."





5	2		3		1
		1			
		2	1		6
	5	6	4		
	4			1	5
	1	5		3	4

Asian Chilli Garlic Prawns

A quick prawn recipe loaded with BIG flavours! Seared prawns smothered in a spicy, sticky Asian sauce, these Asian Chilli Garlic Prawns will have you smacking your lips in utter satisfaction, feeling like you've just dined at a fancy modern Thai restaurant.

The sauce tastes like a homemade Chilli Jam except it's far easier to make. 15 minutes, start to finish!

- ***Ingredients****
- 500g / 1 lb prawns/shrimp, peeled and deveined
- 1 1/2 tbsp vegetable oil
- 1 tsp toasted sesame oil
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 2 tsp ginger, grated or chopped
- 1 tsp chilli flakes
- 1/2 cup water
- 3 tbsp Sriracha
- 2 tsp soy sauce
- 3 tbsp brown sugar
- ***Garnish (Optional)****
- Sesame seeds
- Green onions, sliced
- Red chillies, sliced or chopped
- ***Recipe Notes:****
- Adjust spiciness with chilli flakes, not Sriracha.
- For non-spicy version, use ketchup, rice vinegar, and Shaoxing wine.
- Thaw frozen prawns completely.
- Toasted sesame oil has a stronger flavor.
- Chilli flakes can be substituted with minced chilli.
- Sriracha is a flavorful Asian chilli sauce.

- ***Instructions****
- Heat oil in a skillet over high heat. Sear half the prawns for 45 seconds per side until golden. Remove and repeat with the rest.
- Cool skillet slightly, then return to medium heat. Add sesame oil.
- Cook garlic, ginger, and chilli flakes until garlic is golden.
- Add water, Sriracha, soy sauce, and sugar. Simmer for 3 minutes until sauce thickens.
- Return prawns to skillet, toss in sauce, and cook for 1–2 minutes.
- Garnish and serve with rice or cauliflower rice.

